Md. Sabbir Ahmed

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-Computer Interaction, Human-Centered and Trustworthy AI, Usable Security and Privacy, and Social Computing. I study how people understand, trust, and rely on AI systems and information they cannot fully verify, and how they navigate risks to their privacy and safety, from surveillance to synthetic media. My work centers on marginalized and underrepresented communities in South Asia, with a growing focus on low-resource health and education contexts. I use qualitative, mixed-methods, and computational approaches to study these questions.

EDUCATION

BRAC University *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

Master of Science in Computer Science and Engineering *Jun 2021 – Oct 2025*

- GPA: 4.00 / 4.00
- Thesis: *Understanding the Digital Landscape: Misinformation, Distress, and Diffused Surveillance during the July 2024 Revolution in Bangladesh*
- Thesis Advisors: Md. Golam Rabiul Alam and S. M. Taiabul Haque

BRAC University *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Engineering *Jan 2017 – May 2021*

- GPA: 3.97 / 4.00
- Thesis: *Yield Response of Different Rice Ecotypes to Meteorological, Agro-Chemical, and Soil Physiographic Factors for Interpretable Precision Agriculture Using Extreme Gradient Boosting and Support Vector Regression*
- Thesis Advisor: Md. Golam Rabiul Alam

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Senior Lecturer *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

Department of Computer Science and Engineering, BRAC University *Jan 2026 – Present*

- Conduct research and teach across Human-Computer Interaction, Human-Centered AI, Usable Security and Privacy, Data Science, Machine Learning, and Artificial Intelligence.
- Supervise thesis and research projects, including publication-oriented student research, and contribute to externally funded research initiatives.

Lecturer *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

Department of Computer Science and Engineering, BRAC University *Jan 2023 – Jan 2026*

- Taught undergraduate courses in programming, Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Data Science, and Human-Computer Interaction, while supervising research-oriented student projects.

Lecturer (Contractual) *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

Department of Computer Science and Engineering, BRAC University *Jun 2021 – Dec 2022*

- Taught foundational Computer Science courses and laboratory sections and mentored undergraduate students across multiple semesters.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

Google Scholar (full publication list) | *ORCID*

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS

Mashiyat Mahjabin Eshita*, Ishmam Bin Rofi*, **Md. Sabbir Ahmed***, Dipto Das, Md. Golam Rabiul Alam, Jannatun Noor, Syed Ishtiaque Ahmed, S. M. Taiabul Haque (2026). *Resilience Amid Diffused Surveillance During a Political Movement in Bangladesh*. 35th USENIX Security Symposium (USENIX Security 2026), pp. 3951–3970. *Equal contribution

Ishmam Bin Rofi, Mashiyat Mahjabin Eshita, Avijoy Chakma, **Md. Sabbir Ahmed**, S. M. Taiabul Haque, Jannatun Noor (2025). *The Good, The Bad and The Ugly: The Opportunities, Challenges and the Mitigation Strategies of the*

Young Indigenous Social Media Users of the Chittagong Hill Tracts in Bangladesh. ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2025), Article 135, pp. 1–22. doi:10.1145/3706598.3713268

A. H. B. Sirajul Monir Akib, Mohammad Aseer Intisar, **Md. Sabbir Ahmed**, Marshia Nujhat, Farida Chowdhury (2026). *From Restriction to Empowerment: Responsible AI Governance in Higher Education*. ACM SIGCAS/SIGCHI Conference on Computing and Sustainable Societies (COMPASS 2026), pp. 315–329. doi:10.1145/3811242.3819102

Md. Sabbir Ahmed, K. N. Iqbal, M. G. R. Alam (2023). *Interpretable Lung Cancer Detection Using Explainable AI Methods*. International Conference for Advancement in Technology (ICONAT 2023), pp. 1–6. doi:10.1109/ICONAT57137.2023.10080480

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

Md. Sabbir Ahmed, Md. Tasin Tazwar, Haseen Khan, Swadhin Roy, Junaed Iqbal, Md. Golam Rabiul Alam, Md. Rafiul Hassan, Mohammad Mehedi Hassan (2022). *Yield Response of Different Rice Ecotypes to Meteorological, Agro-Chemical, and Soil Physiographic Factors for Interpretable Precision Agriculture Using Extreme Gradient Boosting and Support Vector Regression*. *Complexity*, 2022. doi:10.1155/2022/5305353

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Md. Sabbir Ahmed, Susmita Biswas, Avijoy Chakma, S. M. Taiabul Haque, Jannatun Noor (2026). *Legible Yet Unheard: Recognition, Wellbeing, and Unequal Knowledge Infrastructures among Indigenous Communities in Bangladesh.* ACM CHI 2027

Md. Sabbir Ahmed, Mashiyat Mahjabin Eshita, Ishmam Bin Rofi, Jannatun Noor (2026). *Balancing the Books and Likes: Student-Informed Design Opportunities for Social Media as a Learning Technology in Tertiary Education.* Australasian Journal of Educational Technology (AJET)

Nabonita Saha, **Md. Sabbir Ahmed**, S. M. Taiabul Haque, Farida Chowdhury (2026). *Conversations Across Time: Cultural and Ethical Perspectives on AI-Mediated Encounters with the Past and the Departed in Bangladesh.* ACM CHI 2027

Mizbaul Haque Maruf, Abdus Sattar, **Md. Sabbir Ahmed** (2026). *"It Looked Right to Me": How the Artifact, Not the Practitioner, Sets the Limits of Verifying AI-Generated Work.* ACM CHI 2027

Md. Atiq Mahbub, Mashiyat Mahjabin Eshita, Argha Pratim Saha, **Md. Sabbir Ahmed**, Md. Sadek Ferdous, Farida Chowdhury (2026). *"I Recognized It Was Probably a Scam, But I Clicked Anyway": Trust, Deception, and the Household Safety Net Among Bangladeshi Young Adults in the Scam Ecosystem.* ACM CHI 2027

MANUSCRIPT IN PREPARATION

Md. Sabbir Ahmed, Dipto Das, S. M. Taiabul Haque, Md. Golam Rabiul Alam (2026). *Beyond Overload: Trust, Crisis-Chondria, and the Drivers of Unverified Sharing During the July 2024 Bangladesh Revolution*.

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Information Trust, Distress, and Diffused Surveillance during the July 2024 Revolution in Bangladesh

Dhaka, Bangladesh

BRAC University *2024 – 2025*

- Led a mixed-methods study of information behavior, digital surveillance, trust, and psychological distress during the July 2024 political movement, combining a survey of 1,162 participants with 23 semi-structured interviews.
- Research outcomes include a co-first-authored paper at the 35th USENIX Security Symposium (USENIX Security 2026) and a first-authored quantitative manuscript introducing the concept of crisis-chondria, currently in preparation for journal submission.

From Silence to Support (S2S): Co-Designing an AI-Assisted Digital Mental Health Intervention for University Students in Bangladesh

Dhaka, Bangladesh

BRAC University *2026 – Present*

- Conceived the project, secured competitive funding, and, as Principal Investigator, lead an interdisciplinary team spanning Computer Science, Law, and Counseling to investigate a human-led, AI-assisted peer-support pathway in which AI serves a bounded first-contact role.
- Lead Study 1, a mixed-methods needs assessment of help-seeking barriers and informal LLM use for emotional support; designed the study instrument and am conducting data collection and analysis. Subsequent studies will examine co-design and prototype evaluation for safety, trustworthiness, usability, and cultural fit.

Navigating the Synthetic Gaze: Trust, Detection, and the Politics of Sharing AI-Generated Content *Bangladesh*

MULTI-COUNTRY SOUTH ASIA RESEARCH COLLABORATION *2026 – Present*

- Serve as the Bangladesh country representative and an active contributor to a multi-country South Asian study examining how users evaluate, trust, detect, and share AI-generated content and deepfakes.
- Contribute to instrument development and the Bangladesh component, focusing on content trust, detection, and AI-content provenance. Status: IRB approved; data collection ongoing.

Learning Trajectories in GCI World: A Study of an Open, Demographically Heterogeneous Data Science Course *Tokyo, Japan, and Dhaka, Bangladesh*

MATSUO-IWASAWA LABORATORY, THE UNIVERSITY OF TOKYO, AND BRAC UNIVERSITY *2026 – Present*

- Serve as the BRAC University point of contact and coordinate the local work package in a multi-site study with the Matsuo-Iwasawa Laboratory, The University of Tokyo, examining learning trajectories, AI use, and educational outcomes in a globally enrolled AI and data science course.
- Status: study design phase; data collection begins October 2026.

COMPETITIVE RESEARCH GRANTS AND FUNDING

From Silence to Support (S2S): Co-Designing an AI-Assisted Digital Mental Health Intervention for University Students in Bangladesh *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

BRAC UNIVERSITY RESEARCH SEED GRANT INITIATIVE (RSGI) *2026 – 2027*

- Principal Investigator; BDT 600,000. Focus: digital mental health, help-seeking, and human-centered AI.

Online Privacy, Digital Security, and Digital Self-Expression Among Indigenous Communities in Bangladesh *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

INSTITUTE FOR ADVANCED RESEARCH (IAR), UNITED INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY *2025 – 2026*

- Co-Investigator; BDT 500,000. Focus: online privacy, digital security, and cultural identity.

Beyond the Bait: Gamified Interventions for Phishing and SMiShing Awareness in Bangladesh's Evolving Cyber Ecosystem *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

BRAC UNIVERSITY RESEARCH SEED GRANT INITIATIVE (RSGI) *2025 – 2026*

- Co-Principal Investigator; BDT 500,000. Focus: usable security and technology-mediated risk awareness.

AI-Integrated Centralized Health Record Management System for Privacy, Patient Accessibility, and Predictive Analytics *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

BRAC UNIVERSITY RESEARCH SEED GRANT INITIATIVE (RSGI) *2025 – 2026*

- Co-Principal Investigator; BDT 500,000. Focus: privacy-preserving health systems and applied AI in healthcare.

ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

Vice Chair, Asia SIGCHI Committee (ASC) *Asia-Pacific*

ACM SIGCHI *2026 – Present*

- Support regional HCI community building, research engagement, and SIGCHI initiatives across Asia.
- Co-leading the organization of the HCI Winter School 2027 in Bangladesh, a five-day regional training and community-building initiative bringing together students, researchers, and HCI faculty from across Asia.

Co-Founder and Assistant Director *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

HUMAN-CENTERED COMPUTING AND SOCIETY (HCCS) RESEARCH GROUP, BRAC UNIVERSITY *Jan 2026 – Present*

- Support strategic research planning, dissemination, community engagement, external collaboration, and coordination among faculty, students, and research partners.

Treasurer *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

ACM SIGCHI DHAKA CHAPTER *2026 – Present*

- Support chapter operations, budgeting, research events, member engagement, and ACM compliance.

Undergraduate Program Coordinator *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

BRAC University *May 2024 – Present*

- Coordinate undergraduate academic advising, program-level processes, degree conferment, curriculum-related activities, and academic administration.

Accreditation, Curriculum, and Industry-Academic Initiatives *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

BRAC University *2023 – Present*

- Contribute to accreditation, Continuous Quality Improvement, and curriculum refinement; serve as institutional contact for AWS Academy and Microsoft Learn for Educators.

SCHOLARLY SERVICE

Program Committee Member, COMPASS 2026

ACM SIGCAS/SIGCHI Conference on Computing and Sustainable Societies *2026*

- Reviewed 6 submissions as part of the conference peer-review process.

Reviewer, *Computers and Electronics in Agriculture*

Elsevier *2023 – Present*

- Completed 15 manuscript reviews.

Technical Committee Member, ICCAI 2025

11th International Conference on Computing and Artificial Intelligence *2025*

- Reviewed 2 submissions.

RESEARCH MENTORING AND SUPERVISION

Department of Computer Science and Engineering, BRAC University *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

Undergraduate Thesis and Project Supervision *2022 – Present*

- Supervised or co-supervised more than 30 undergraduate thesis and project groups across Human-Computer Interaction, Human-Centered AI, Data Science, Machine Learning, Computer Vision, and Usable Security and Privacy.

AWARDS AND HONORS

Excellence in Service Award *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

Department of Computer Science and Engineering, BRAC University *2025, 2026*

Merit Scholarships for Academic Excellence *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

BRAC University *2018 – 2022*

- Received multiple merit-based scholarships during undergraduate and graduate studies, including a full merit scholarship during the MSc program while maintaining a 4.00/4.00 GPA.

Vice Chancellor's List, Nine Consecutive Semesters *Dhaka, Bangladesh*

BRAC University *2018 – 2021*

RESEARCH METHODS AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Qualitative Methods	Semi-structured interviews, focus groups, thematic analysis, and interpretive analysis
Quantitative & Mixed Methods	Survey research, descriptive and inferential statistics, and regression analysis
HCI & Human-Centered AI	Usability evaluation, trust and interpretability studies, and technology-use research
Machine Learning & XAI	Supervised & unsupervised learning, ensemble methods, interpretability, and feature attribution
Programming & Tools	Python, scikit-learn, TensorFlow/Keras, Java, LaTeX, and Git
Languages	English (IELTS Academic 7.5, CEFR C1, 2026); Bangla (native)